



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Leadership Academy of Utah

School Website: <https://lautah.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

Overall Classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Leadership Academy of Utah (LAU) presents a largely classical-oriented program anchored in a liberal arts approach and leadership formation, with explicit emphasis on mentor-led instruction, student leadership development, and a Williamsburg Curriculum that foregrounds discussion, projects, and engagement with historical thinkers. Public materials highlight formation goals (growth, transformation, leadership) and a strong parental-partnership ethos, while curriculum and pedagogy evidence show liberal arts framing, live discussions, and an emphasis on projects and leadership training. However, explicit theological or liturgical foundations and certain classical hallmarks (e.g., explicit Great Books culture, or explicit Socratic seminars across upper grades) are less overt in LAU's public materials than foundational classical rubrics would require. Overall, LAU skews toward CLASSICAL in several categories but exhibits notable gaps in catechetical or liturgical language and explicit Great Books/Socratic pedagogy. Aggregate classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with clear movement potential in religious/metaphysical foundations, curriculum explicit Great Books integration, and pedagogy.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Public materials emphasize character formation and transformation, leadership, and virtue-oriented aims, with statements like "Education at its core is the growth and transformation of the student" and "cultivating the next generations to be wise and successful." There is no explicit theological or liturgical framework in the public materials.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive cues include transformation, wisdom, virtue (implicit), leadership; no clear theological or liturgical keywords appear. Positive keyword density exists but lacks explicit transcendental metaphysical language.
 - Why this rating: The school foregrounds character formation and virtue indirectly, but does not overtly ground education in theology or liturgical community life in public-facing content. Hence, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Public statements frame education as formation and leadership development (not merely job prep), e.g., "Education at its core is the growth and transformation of the student" and "cultivating future leaders."
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include transformation, growth, leadership, formation. No explicit "truth, goodness, beauty" trinity is stated, and there is limited explicit virtue-theory language beyond leadership formation.
 - Why this rating: Formation and leadership emphasis align with classical aims, but absence of explicit virtues/truth/beauty language and absence of a clearly stated triad makes it not fully CLASSICAL. CATEGORY sits in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: LAU publicly promotes a liberal arts education framed by the Williamsburg Curriculum, with emphasis on thinking, engaging discussions, and original works of history's thinkers; program is

described as a liberal arts education featuring leadership and meaningful projects. It also emphasizes live discussions and projects, and discusses high-level courses within a rigorous framework.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Liberal Arts Education, Williamsburg Curriculum, engaging discussions, meaningful projects, original works of history's thinkers (Great Books-like framing), leadership training, mentors. These align strongly with classical content (grammar/logic/rhetoric articulation is implied in "Williamsburg" structure and Writing/Rhetoric references in grade-level materials). No explicit negative curricular indicators observed.
- Why this rating: The curriculum centers liberal arts, discussion, and reading of historical thinkers, with a structured, mentor-supported program. These map well to classical criteria, supporting a CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum.
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Public materials describe engaging discussions, projects, and leadership mentorship; live-online classes with debates/discussions are present; the program emphasizes mentoring and student leadership. However, explicit Socratic seminars, formal rhetoric training, or a grade-level progression into Socratic discourse is not consistently evidenced in public content.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include engaging discussions, meaningful projects, mentors, leadership training. Absence of explicit Socratic seminars, formal classic rhetoric instruction, or "Scholé" contemplative pedagogy is notable.
- Why this rating: The pedagogy shows classical tendencies (discussion, projects, mentor-led learning) but lacks consistent explicit evidence of higher-order classical methods like sustained Socratic seminars, rigorous rhetoric training, or disciplined scholé routines in public materials. Hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: LAU highlights mentors as teachers, "the living curriculum," and high standards for faculty development and mentorship; teachers are described as engaged, caring, and capable of inspiring leadership. There is emphasis on mentors who model virtue and leadership, with professional development and high standards for mentors.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include mentors, living curriculum, high standards, professional development, engagement, inspiration. No explicit negative faculty indicators observed.
- Why this rating: The faculty model as mentors, the living curriculum, and strong professional development align well with classical ideals of a virtuous, exemplary teaching staff, supporting CLASSICAL.
- Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: LAU positions parents as co-teachers; explicit language that parents play the leading role in a student's education; offers parent resources, a three-step plan, and opportunities for parent involvement; invites parent participation and visits.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include parents as co-teachers, parent involvement, parent support resources, three-step plan, open-door accessibility. No explicit negative indicators.
- Why this rating: A robust, explicit partnership model with parents, ongoing parent education, and welcoming access aligns strongly with classical expectations in the Parents & Community category.

Aggregate assessment - Classical: 2 categories (Curriculum, Faculty, and to a degree Parents & Community) lean Classical; 3 categories (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, Purpose & Goal, Pedagogy) are Somewhat Classical; 1 category (if forced) could be argued as Not Classical for Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, but given formation language it's more accurately Somewhat Classical. - Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Strengthen Religious and Metaphysical Foundations with explicit theology or metaphysical framing (e.g., a stated transcendental moral realism, liturgical/civic communal practices, or a clearly articulated theology-in-discipline integration) to reach a CLASSICAL level in Element 1. Evidence would include explicit mentions of truth, goodness, beauty as real, transcendent ideals, and liturgical or communal practices integrated into daily life. Suggested moves: publish a formal statement or plan that articulates theological or metaphysical anchors, develop liturgical/communal practices, incorporate explicit references to the true/good/beautiful triad in mission and curriculum.
- Explicitly anchor curriculum to Great Books and a “Great Conversation” framework with clear references to grammar, logic, and rhetoric as a progression (especially with K–8 strong literacy and logic foundations and high school seminars). Evidence would include a stated Great Books reading list, explicit history-as-history curriculum across all grades, and explicit logic/rhetoric progression.
- Expand explicit Socratic pedagogy in upper grades (9–12) with defined seminars, debates, and formal rhetoric instruction, plus clear assessment of rhetoric and public speaking.
- Expand a formal “Scholé” cadence (calm, contemplative study blocks) and explicit contemplative practices within the schedule to align with classical pedagogy expectations.
- Continue to articulate and perhaps broaden the parental education program (book studies, parent groups) to deepen the co-teacher model, while maintaining open-visit policy to strengthen the Parents & Community category.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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